

Selenopeltis

The common trilobite *Selenopeltis* lived in cool waters along the coast of Gondwana, a mighty prehistoric continent that later broke apart to form South America, Africa, and Australia. It had long, sweeping spines that give its fossils a graceful appearance, making them a favorite among fossil collectors.

Selenopeltis

se-LEE-no-pel-tiss



- **When** 471–445 million years ago (Early to Late Ordovician)
- **Fossil location** British Isles, France, Iberia, Morocco, Czech Republic, Turkey
- **Habitat** Ocean waters
- **Length** Up to 4½ in (12 cm)

Selenopeltis had a wide skeleton and a distinctive squarish head. Spines extended backward from its cheeks and the sides of each body segment. Unlike most other trilobites, it had small eyes.

